MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including ownership of GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams. Built ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster, with namespace-level access; reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes. Hands-on experience with Terraform for personal Hetzner VPS infrastructure, GitOps and observability; flaky-test rates fell from 7% to under 2%. Enable QA, product and development teams through review environments, CI documentation and onboarding.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers).
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to under 2%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote an internal guide to CI pipelines used in team onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Set up a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from Git with Argo CD.
- Implemented monitoring and logging with Prometheus, Grafana and Loki; configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Designed short-lived per-merge-request environments containing the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Enabled QA and product stakeholders to review features before merge and supported end-to-end tests against each environment; automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 2% after teams began addressing the most frequent offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split e2e tests into a separate stage.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level, 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation — exam scheduled for January 2027; not yet certified.

SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm
Infrastructure and platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm charts for test environments), k3s, Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems, networking and security tooling: Linux, Git, Traefik ingress, cert-manager, TLS certificate management.
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)